

CONOR KIRKBY

JUNIOR GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS PROGRAMMER

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SUMMARY

Gameplay programmer with strong experience in Unreal Engine and C++ aswell as Unity and C#. Specialising in game systems, optimisation and debugging with experience working on a government funded title at DunDev. Comfortable collaborating within teams and reading, modifying and extending existing codebases, bringing a detailed and professional approach to development.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SAE Institute | Game Programming Lecturer

Dec 2025 - Present

- Organising and updating relevant course materials outlined by the module leader and module briefs.
- Meeting with other Lecturers to discuss collaboration between classes.
- Delivering course materials and organising workshops for the students in a professional manner.
- Providing extra help, communication and support to the students with both academic and technical issues.

Purr Point Productions | Programmer → Lead Programmer

Sept 2024 - Sept 2025

- Developed or maintained 30+ player abilities using enumeration logic and maps, providing an efficient fundamental system that allows adding new abilities a simple task.
- Expanded AI implementation by modifying 8 existing AI behaviours and implementing 4 new AI characters using Behaviour Trees, Animation Blueprints and actor based systems.
- Contributed to front and backend development, implementing systems across gameplay, AI, animation, UI, and managers while collaborating closely with designers and the lead programmer.
- Identified and resolved several performance issues, improving FPS, reducing CPU and memory usage and delivering smoother gameplay, including on the Steam Deck.
- Managed source control for entire team, including department merges, resolving conflicts, creating stable builds and providing guidance with GitHub.
- Took over as Lead Programmer, now responsible for system design, cross-department collaboration and the onboarding and training a new team member.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** C++, C#, Unreal Blueprints, Java, Python, HTML, CSS.
- **Development Skills:** AI, Gameplay, Animation, UI, Systems, Optimisation, Debugging.
- **Project Management:** Jira, Trello, HacknPlan
- **Source Control:** Git, GitHub, GitKraken, JetBrains Rider(GitHub integration)
- **Engines:** Unreal Engine, Unity.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science (Hons) - GPA: 1st
SAE Institute | London

Sep 2022- Aug 2024

PROJECTS

Echronia | Unreal Engine | [Portfolio Link](#) | [GitHub Link](#)

Oct 2025 - Present

Personal Project (Under early development)

- Turn based combat with multiple faction implementation into enemy decision making.
- Created grid based pathfinding using the A* method.
- Early combat development stages.
- Created a simple data configuration to allow configuration of many actors at once.
- Created my own grid building Unreal Editor tool.

Cat-A-Strophic | Unreal Engine | [Portfolio Link](#)

Sept 2024 - Sept 2025

Purr Point Productions

- UK Government Funded.
- Participated in the Tranzfuser & Dundev programmes.
 - [Steam](#)
 - [Itch.io](#)

Dark Alma | Unreal Engine | [Portfolio Link](#) | [Itch.io Link](#)

Apr 2024

University project

- One of my proudest early works of development.
- The combined knowledge all all previous semesters into this one souls-like project.
- Developed a two stage boss encounter with various attacks and behaviours.
- Developed two minion enemies, one melee and one ranged for the player to fight.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

University Academic Projects | [Projects Link](#)

Sept 2022 - Aug 2024

- Learned the fundamentals of programming principles including algorithms, data structures, functions, logic flow and the use of Unreal Engine and Unity with blueprints and C#.
- Learned team dynamics and how to develop a project as part of a group and the delegation of tasks.
- Developed 7 projects of increasing quality from minor gameplay features to eventual full gameplay loops aswell as multiple workshops to sharpen my skills.

Game Jams

- Brackey's Game Jam 2023
- Global Game Jam 2024
- GMTK Game Jam 2024 - Self taught C++ from scratch during this game jam.